



Theme 11 B – Manontany sy manoro lalana sy toerana (Tohiny 2)

Asking for and giving directions to a road or place (continued 2)

Introduction

In Madagascar, **only in large towns** do streets usually have names or numbers.

In most places, people use **landmarks** instead.

1. Questions for asking about places and directions

When asking, Malagasy speakers **always use azafady (please)** first, then either ask the question directly or begin with an introductory phrase like “*Could you show/tell me...*”

Example – asking how to find the hospital:

- **Azafady, aiza ny hôpitaly eto ?** (off)

Azafady, aiza moa lôpitaly aketo ? (tsm)

→ “Please, where is the hospital here?”

- **Azafady, afaka manoro ahy ny hôpitaly eto ve ianao ?** (off)

Azafady, afaka manoro zaho ny lôpitaly aketo moa anao ? (tsm)

→ “Please, could you show me where the hospital is here?”

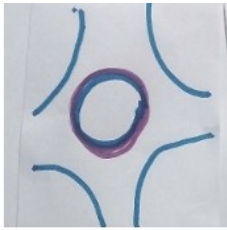


Here are some other questions used to ask for directions or places.

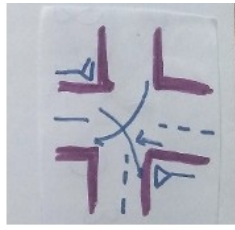
To practise, you can replace **(place)** with **Mandritsara** (for #1 to #7) and with **ny banky** (the bank) for #6, #8 and #9.

#	Malagasy (off / tsm)	English meaning
1	An’inona eto azafady ? (off) / An’ino moa aketo azafady ? (tsm)	“What is this place, please?” / “Where is this place, please?”
2	Azafady, aiza ny lalana mandeha any (place) ?	“Please, where is the road that goes to ...?”
3	Azafady, ity ve ny lalana mankany (place) ? (off) / Azafady, tôho moa lalana mankany (place) ? (tsm)	“Please, is this the right way to ...?”
4	Azafady, ahoana ny fomba andehanana any (place) ? (off) / Azafady, manakory mandeha any (place) ? (tsm)	“Please, how do I get to ...?”
5	(Place) ve eto azafady ? (off) / (Place) moa aketo azafady ? (tsm)	“Is ... here, please?”
6	Mbola lavitra avy eto ve (place) azafady ? (off) / Mbola lavitra avaketo moa (place) azafady ? (tsm)	“Please, is ... still far from here?”
7	Adiny firy avy eto ny (place) azafady ? (off) / Firy lera avaketo moa ny (place) azafady ? (tsm)	“Please, how many hours from here is ...?”
8	Aiza ny (place) eto azafady ? (off) / Aiza ny (place) aketo azafady ? (tsm)	“Please, where is ... here?”
9	Azafady, misy (place) ve akaiky eto ? (off) / Misy (place) moa marigny aketo azafady ? (tsm)	“Please, is there a ... near here?”

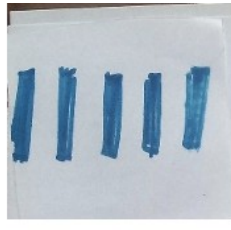
2. Nouns and prepositions for describing a place



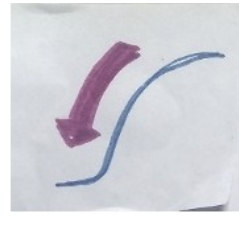
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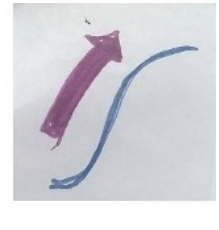
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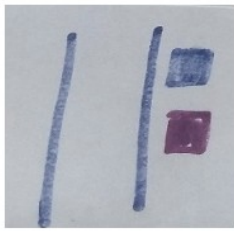
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A. Common place words

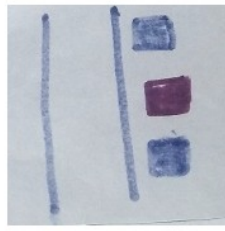


Malagasy (off / tsm)	English	Malagasy (off / tsm)	English
1. Fihodinana	Roundabout	6. Tetezana (off) / Pont (tsm)	Bridge
2. Sampanan-dàlana	Crossroads	7. Fiangonana	Church
3. Fiampitana	Crossing / Pedestrian crosswalk	8. Fijanonan'ny bus	Bus stop
4. Fidinana	Descent	9. Ankavia	Left
5. Fiakarana (off) / Fakaragna (tsm)	Ascent	10. Ankavanana (off) / Ankahery (tsm)	Right

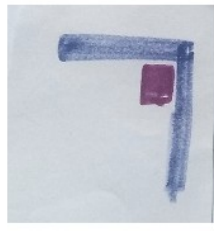
B. Prepositions and location words



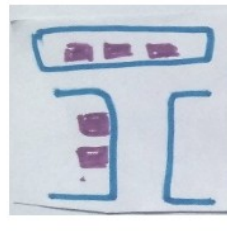
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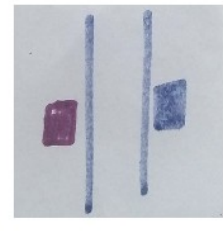
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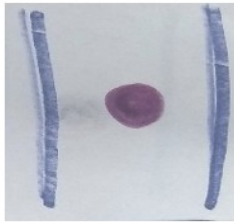
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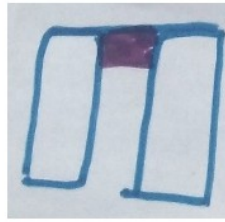
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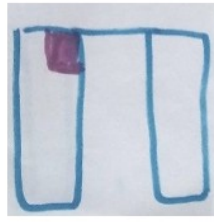
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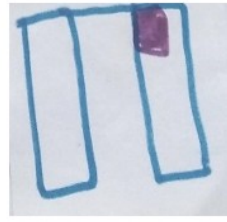
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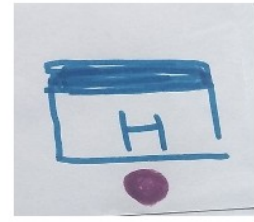
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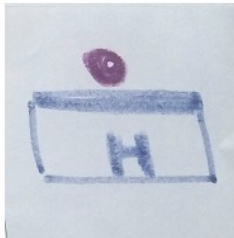
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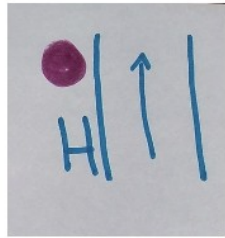
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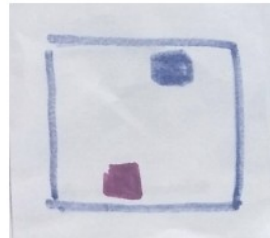
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Malagasy (off / tsm)	English	Malagasy (off / tsm)	English
1. Akaiky	Next to / Near	8. Farany ankavia	At the end (on the left)
2. Anelanelana	Between	9. Farany ankavanana	At the end (on the right)
3. Zoro / Amin'ny zoro	Corner / At the corner	10. Anoloana (off) / Alohaka (tsm)	In front of
4. Amorona	At the side / By the edge	11. Andamosina (off) / Afara (tsm)	Behind
5. Ampita	Across / Opposite	12. Aloha (off) / Alohaka (tsm)	Before
6. Afovoany (off) / Anivo (tsm)	In the middle of	13. Aoriana (off) / Afara (tsm)	After
7. Amin'ny faran'ny ...	At the end of	14. Amin'ny ilany	On the other side

3. Practice – Understanding and building sentences

Try to understand the structure of these examples, then write your **own sentences** describing the place where you live, using vocabulary from section 2.



Examples – “It’s the...”

- *Ny fiampitana akaikin’ny fiangonana.* → “It’s the crossing near the church.”
- *Ny fiakarana aorinan’ny hôpitaly.* → “It’s the ascent after the hospital.”
- *Ny tetezana anelanelan’ny fiangonana sy ny hôpitaly.* → “It’s the bridge between the church and the hospital.”
- *Ny fijanonan’ny bus ankavian’ny fiangonana.* → “It’s the bus stop to the left of the church.”
- *Ny fiangonana amin’ny faran’ny lâlana.* → “It’s the church at the end of the road.”
- *Ny hôpitaly ampitan’ny fiangonana.* → “It’s the hospital opposite the church.”

Examples – “The ... is ...”



- *Anoloan’ny hôpitaly ny fiampitana.* → “The crossing is in front of the hospital.”
- *Amoron-dâlana ny fiangonana.* → “The church is by the roadside.”
- *Andamosin’ny hôpitaly ny fijanonan’ny bus.* → “The bus stop is behind the hospital.”
- *Amin’ny faran’ny lâlana ankavia ny fiangonana.* → “The church is at the end of the street on the left.”
- *Akaikin’ny tetezana ny hôpitaly.* → “The hospital is next to the bridge.”
- *Amin’ny zoron-dâlana ny hôpitaly.* → “The hospital is at the corner of the street.”